northwind

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

Northwind launches Kestrel, a warehouse robot that learns new pick routes in under an hour

The autonomous picker cuts onboarding from weeks to an afternoon and is available today to mid-sized retailers in the UK and EU.

MANCHESTER, 27 October 2026 — Northwind Robotics today announced Kestrel, an autonomous mobile picking robot designed for warehouses between 5,000 and 50,000 square metres. Kestrel maps a new site and learns optimal pick routes in under 60 minutes, compared with the two-to-six weeks typical of current systems.

Early customers including Oakhouse Home and Brightfield Pharmacy report picking-rate improvements of 38% and a 52% reduction in walking time for floor staff, who now focus on packing and quality checks.

> *"Warehouses change every week — new stock, new layouts, peak season. Kestrel is the first robot that keeps up without a consultant on site."*
>
> — Priya Raman, CEO, Northwind Robotics

Kestrel works alongside people, slowing and re-routing automatically around staff. It integrates with major warehouse management systems through a single API and requires no floor markers or reflectors.

Pricing starts at £1,450 per robot per month, including maintenance and software updates. A free two-week pilot is available for qualifying sites.

> *"We were live on a Tuesday afternoon. By Friday our pickers were asking for more robots."*
>
> — Tom Ellery, Ops Director, Oakhouse Home

Kestrel is available to order today at northwind.ai/kestrel, with first deliveries in January 2027.

About Northwind Robotics — Founded in 2021 in Manchester, Northwind builds adaptable robots for logistics. The company has raised £64M from Atomico and Octopus Ventures and employs 140 people.

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